

## It's a Numbers Game

The banks and credit card companies like the idea of using a credit score because it is designed to keep us paying them as much as possible, for as long as possible. They try to make the scoring system sound official, and complicated, and try to indicate that the credit score is used in order for them to be “fair.”

In some regards it is. Using numbers and data to evaluate if a person should get a loan or not was the original intent of credit reports and credit scores. It was supposed to be an objective way that every lender could have the same information to make a decision on whether or not they should give you a loan or a credit card. The credit report is like a big report card of every credit test you have ever taken. For most of us, we didn't even know we were taking a test. Every month, our paying habits are turned over to the watchdogs. Having a way to track a person's credit record is a good tool for the lenders. It is not a good system for the consumer.

The system has morphed over time. What they don't want you to know is that credit score system is rigged *against* the consumer. The banks like the credit score's way of doing business because the score calculation is devised to keep you in their vise grip for a long, long time.

## Not for Your Eyes Only

We will delve more into credit scores, credit reports, and credit reporting agencies, but for now, it is important for you to be familiar with the words they use. A credit report is a veritable treasure trove of information about you and your money. That information is no one's business but yours. And the government's. And the credit card companies'. And the bank's. And the mortgage broker's. And....

If you are wondering if anyone but the banks and lenders can look at your credit report, the answer is a definitive “yes.” Who all is allowed to take a gander? A whole gaggle of people. Any business, individual, or government agency may request a credit report for its legitimate business needs involving a transaction with the consumer. Valid reasons for a company to review your credit report and credit score could include: credit granting considerations; review or collection